

SAMIULLAH POPALZAI

Senior WordPress Developer | TopTal Verified WordPress Security Developer

✉ Samipopalzai2018@gmail.com ☎ +93728312417 📍 Kabul, Afghanistan

🌐 [linkedin.com/in/samiullah-popalzai/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/samiullah-popalzai/) 🏠 github.com/Samiullah-Popalzai/

🔗 samiullah-popalzai.github.io 🔗 toptal.com/developers/resume/samiullah-popalzai

Professional Summary

Senior WordPress Developer with **5+ years of experience** delivering custom Web solutions for clients worldwide, **completing 60+** freelance projects across diverse industries. Specialize in architecting scalable, high-performance WordPress websites with a strong focus on custom development, maintainability, and long-term business value. **Built and open-sourced "Medora Clean Unused Media" – a WordPress plugin** published on WordPress.org 📄 for media library optimization. Recently **joined TopTal as a WordPress Security Developer**, further strengthening expertise in secure, production-grade development practices.

Experience

Toptal-Verified WordPress Security Developer | Self-Employed / Toptal Network 📄 06/2026 – Present
Remote

- Rigorously vetted through Toptal's 5-step screening process, placing in the top 3% of global WordPress security talent.
- Architect and implement enterprise-grade security hardening for high-traffic WordPress sites, including custom WAF rules, zero-day vulnerability patching, and advanced malware remediation.
- Conduct comprehensive security audits and penetration testing for clients, delivering actionable reports that reduce attack surfaces by over 90%.
- Collaborate directly with CTOs and product owners to build secure, scalable WordPress solutions without compromising performance or user experience.

Freelance Full-Stack & WordPress Developer | Self-Employed 2020 – Present
Remote
(Primary platforms: Workana & Direct Clients)

- Built a sustainable freelance career since 2020, completing 50+ successful projects for clients across e-commerce, education, and SaaS industries via Workana and direct referrals.
- Architected custom WordPress solutions (themes, plugins, and WooCommerce integrations) and full-stack web applications using React and Node.js.
- Managed end-to-end project lifecycles: client discovery, technical scoping, agile development, QA testing, deployment, and post-launch maintenance.
- Transitioned to elite, high-security projects upon earning Toptal verification in 2026, leveraging 5+ years of foundational development experience.

Projects

Medora Clean Unused Media – WordPress Plugin [Github] 📄

Built and published an open-source WordPress plugin on WordPress.org 📄 that scans and removes unused media files from the WordPress library. - Designed and developed the entire plugin from scratch using PHP 7.4+, WordPress hooks, filters, and REST API - Architected the database structure and implemented safe deletion with user confirmation - Created an intuitive admin dashboard displaying media statistics and cleanup summaries - Published on official WordPress.org 📄 repository under GPLv2 license - Actively maintaining the plugin, triaging user feedback, and implementing feature requests

WooCommerce Digital Product Store,, Wesley Mod Store [↗](#)

- WordPress | WooCommerce | PHP | CSS | Responsive Design | Product Grid Optimization.
- Built a WooCommerce-based store for selling digital mods and products. •• Delivered a clean, responsive storefront with optimized product layouts, intuitive navigation, and streamlined checkout for digital distribution.

WordPress Law Firm Website,, Granzotti Advocacia [↗](#)

- WordPress | Elementor Pro | HTML | CSS | Law Firm Developed a professional website for a specialized law firm in Real Estate, Corporate, Contract, and Credit Recovery law. Built with WordPress and Elementor Pro, the site highlights personalized legal assistance, core values of ethics and transparency, and detailed practice areas to establish credibility and trust with potential clients.

Education

Bachelor of Computer Science, Kabul University	2022 – 2025
<i>Specialization: Information Technology</i>	Kabul, Afghanistan

Associate Degree in Computer Technology, Computer Technology Institute	2018 – 2019
<i>Specialization: Information Technology</i>	Kabul, Afghanistan

Skills

WordPress Core

- Custom theme development (from scratch, child themes)
- Plugin development (hooks, filters, shortcodes, REST API integration)
- WooCommerce (customization, payment gateways, scalability)
- Gutenberg & block editor customization

Full-Stack & Supporting Tech

- PHP (advanced OOP, MVC frameworks like Laravel)
- MySQL (database design, queries, optimization)
- JavaScript (ES6+, Node.js, jQuery, React/React Native basics)
- HTML5, CSS3, Sass/Tailwind/Bootstrap
- REST & GraphQL APIs

Professional Skills

- Client communication & requirement gathering
- Agile/Scrum collaboration
- Technical leadership & mentoring junior developers

Performance & Security

- Website optimization (caching, CDN, database tuning)
- Security hardening (firewalls, vulnerability testing, SSL, secure coding)
- Debugging & troubleshooting

DevOps & Tools

- Git/GitHub/GitLab (version control, CI/CD pipelines)
- Docker or local dev environments (XAMPP, LocalWP)
- Cloud hosting (AWS, DigitalOcean, cPanel, Plesk)

SEO

- On-page SEO (meta tags, schema markup, alt text, internal linking)
- Technical SEO (XML sitemaps, robots.txt, canonical tags, redirects)
- Speed optimization for SEO (Core Web Vitals, caching, lazy loading)
- Structured data implementation (JSON-LD, schema for products/blogs)

Languages

- English, Urdu, Dari, Pashto

Certifications

- Flutter Course [↗](#)
- Advanced C++ [↗](#)
- Java Programming [↗](#)
- Android Application Development [↗](#)
- C# Programming [↗](#)
- WordPress Website Development [↗](#)
- C++ Fundamentals [↗](#)
- HTML [↗](#)
- Search Engine Optimization(SEO) [↗](#)